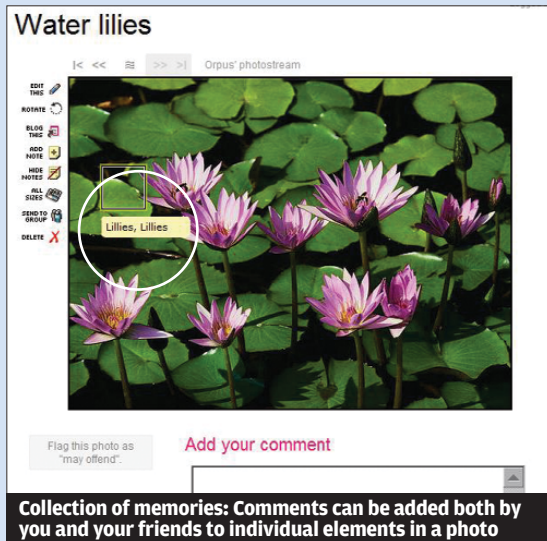


Flickr.com

Here's an online photo-sharing stopover that offers beyond the usual album creation tools



Suprotip Ghosh

Flickr.com is a photo management application, an online site for sharing photos. It stands out for its user-friendliness, intuitive interface, design, and the emphasis on the fact that sharing photos means sharing memories. True to this spirit, anyone can log on to Flickr and actually post a remark, add a tag, or simply comment on any photo. Flickr supports camera phones as well—photos clicked on camera phones can be directly e-mailed to your Flickr page.

Registration

A basic account on Flickr is free. However, there is a 10 MB upload limit per month on free accounts. The terms and conditions page reflects the spirit of the site admirably—“We claim no intellectual property rights over the material you provide to the Flickr service. Your profile and materials uploaded remain yours.”

Getting Started

After the brief registration process, a profile page shows up, where you can optionally, at any time, fill in a few personal details. You are then taken straight to the home page. Fairly straightforward and self-explanatory links on the right ensure great usability. You can also specify here whether the photos you upload are to be private, or can be viewed by everyone on the Net.

Uploading Photos

You can either click on a link and upload a photo directly on the Web site. You can also download one of the plugins available for most popular OSes, and upload through it.

Tagging And Description

The next page allows for more detailed tagging. Descriptions can be added to the photos here.

Your Photos!

This page is where you see all the photos you have uploaded. The page also contains the links you need to organise and upload. It links to your user profile, a calendar, a few other necessary links, and a tag-search engine. The page contains the archive, as well as an upload history.



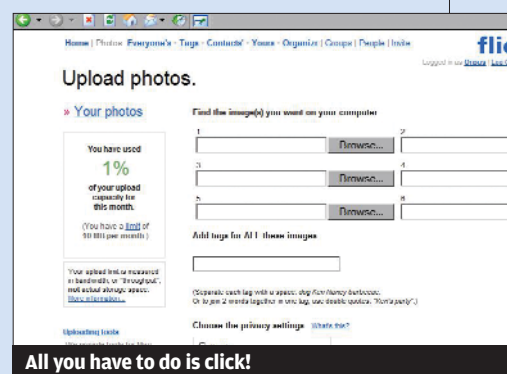
The Organizer

The neatest link on the photos page is the Organizer. This interface supports drag-and-drop, complete with a timeline at the bottom that contains reminders about which photo has been uploaded, and when. You can create a 'photoset', or manage your group(s).

"Edit these as a batch"

This link points back to the tagging and description page. There is enough flexibility to either update photo description and tags one by one, or as a bunch.

Every page has



a navigation bar on top that includes, among others, the following links:

Everyone's

This is a preview of photos picked up either randomly, or from among the most recently posted stuff on the site. You can search according to tags, or according to a list of pre-specified favourites.

Contacts

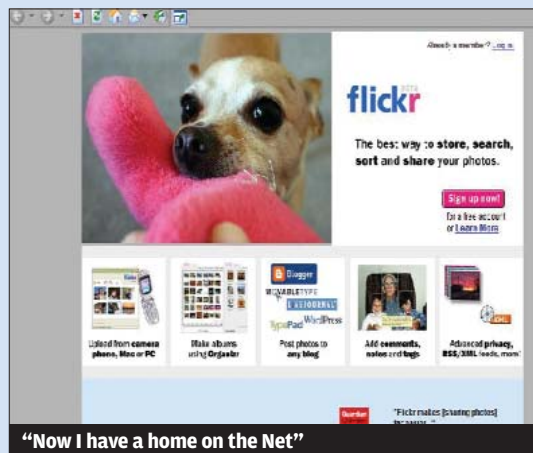
This page keeps track of your contacts and their activities on the site.

Groups, People and Invite are community tools to locate or track people, and join groups.

There are a few features apart from all the above, including:

- ☐ A mobile version of the Web site so you can see the latest photos on your web-enabled cell phone or PDA
- ☐ Group photo pools, so everyone at a wedding, for example, can put their photos in one place ☐

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flickr
The best way to store, search, sort and share your photos.
Blog, E-mail Photos
ON Flickr.com you can blog your photos on all the major blogging sites. You can even upload photos directly from your camera phone into Flickr. There is an e-mail address set up for you. All you need to do is enter that e-mail address into your Web-enabled cell phone and send it Flickr's way!